CROSSWORD ADVENTURES

BONUS PUZZLES

6 free puzzles, one from each level of the book Crossword Adventures: 100 Puzzles for Kids 8 and Up. They start easy and get harder, just like the book. The answers are at the back.

Puzzle 1 Level 1: Warm-Up
Small 5 x 5 and 7 x 7 grids with a Word Bank and starter letters. One helper goes away at a time.

Puzzle 2 Level 2: On Your Own
Small 7 x 7 grids, clues only. No helpers now!

Puzzle 3 Level 3: Explorer
Medium 9 x 9 grids with more words to find.

Puzzle 4 Level 4: Adventurer
Large 11 x 11 grids with longer words.

Puzzle 5 Level 5: Expert
Large 11 x 11 grids with harder words and trickier clues. Work out the hidden theme yourself!

Puzzle 6 Level 6: Champion
Biggest 13 x 13 grids in the book. Can you finish them all?

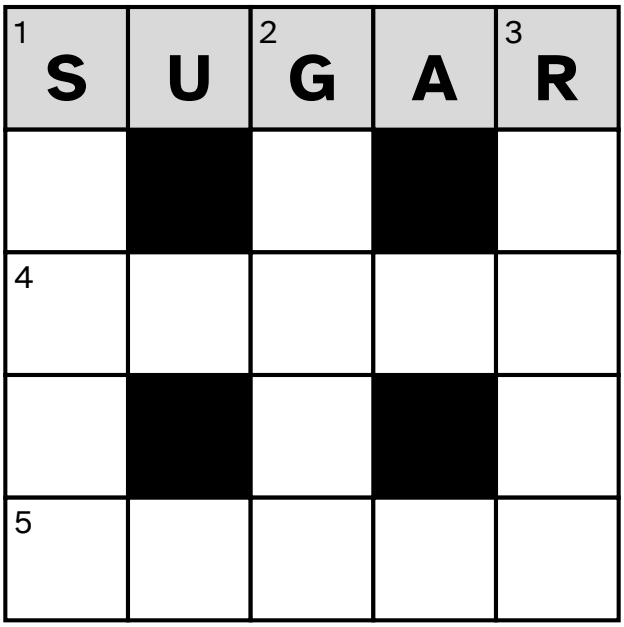
Color certificates and more: crosswordadventures.com/adventuresone

Puzzle 1

Level 1: Warm-Up

Cookie Jar

2 foods are hiding in this puzzle. Look for 🍎



Welcome! These first puzzles teach you how crosswords work, one step at a time. How to play: No clues this time! Count the boxes for each word, then find a word in the Word Bank with that many letters. One word is already done for you, so use its letters to help place the others.

Word Bank

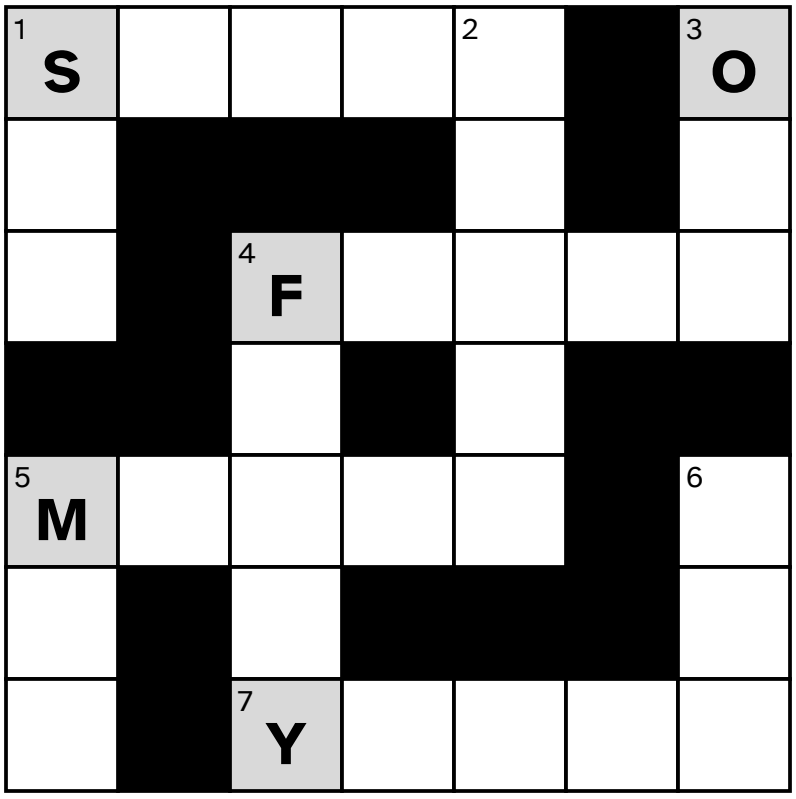
EIGHT GOING ICING 🍎 RIGHT SMILE SUGAR 🍎

Puzzle 2

Level 2: On Your Own

Blast Off!

3 space words are hiding in this puzzle. Can you find them?



Level 2: no Word Bank now! The first few puzzles still have a few letters filled in. Count the boxes to see how long each answer is, fill in the clues you're sure about, and let crossing letters help with the rest.

Across

1. Home of the Milky Way
4. A gold medal means you came in ___
5. May or March
7. A puppy is a ___ dog

Down

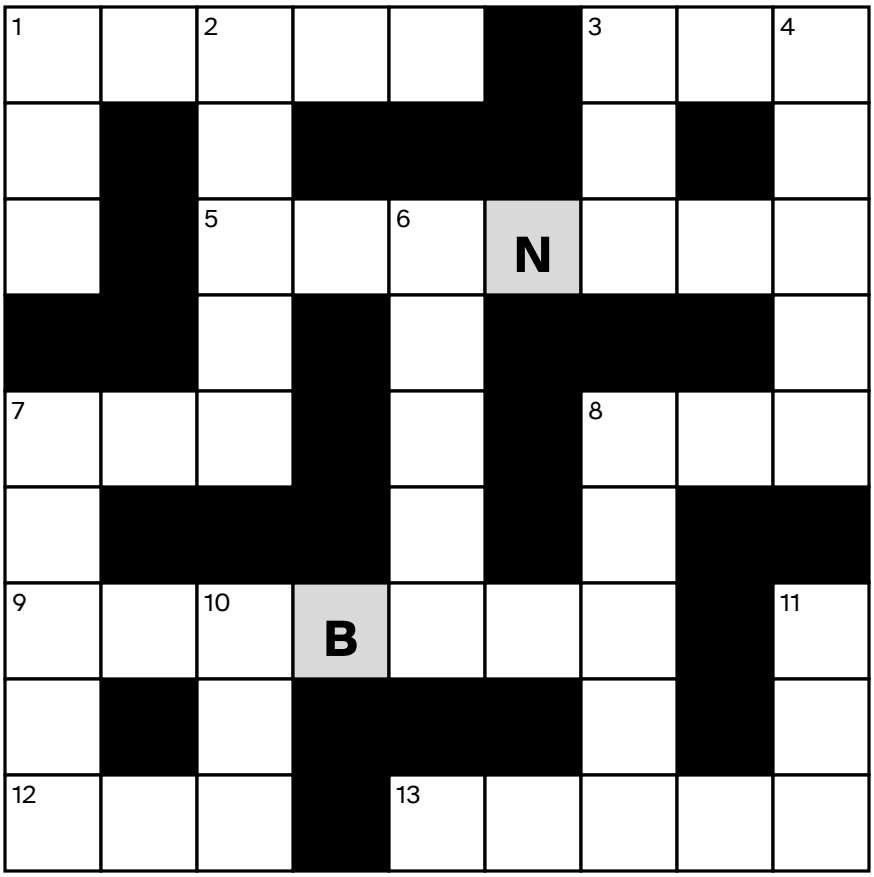
1. Our planet travels around it once a year
2. Our home planet
3. Take the trash ___
4. A good joke is ___
5. Find our town on this
6. A big squeeze with both arms

Puzzle 3

Stretch and Bend

Level 3: Explorer

5 body parts are hiding in this puzzle. Can you find them?



Level 3: a bigger grid! Work one corner at a time. If a crossing letter doesn't fit, one of the two words is wrong, so check both.

Across

1. Ouch! A ___ flop into the pool
3. Your elbow is in the middle of it
5. Canada is one, and so is Mexico
7. You ___ for things at a store
8. Your big ___ is on your foot
9. "No ___!" means it is easy
12. Ella ___ to the finish line
13. Poems often do this at the end of lines

Down

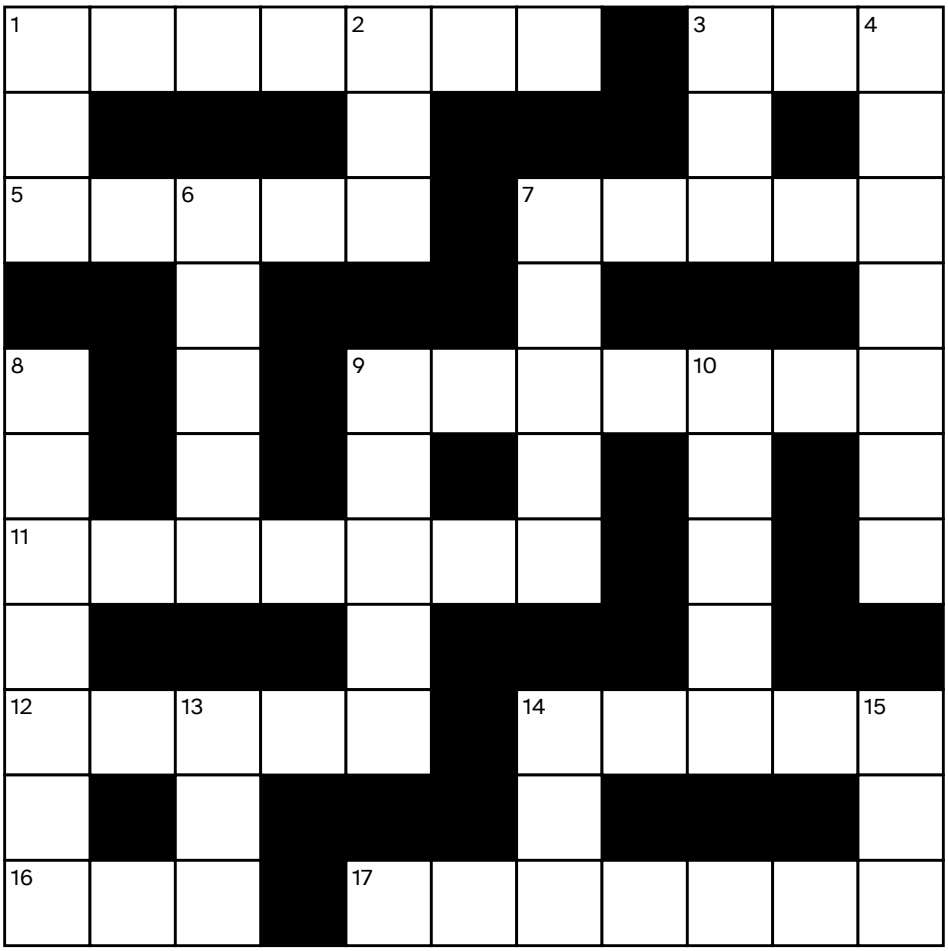
1. Ride this to school
2. Having good things happen by chance
3. ___ out a story in the school show
4. "We'll see," or "Possibly"
6. Wait here ___ the bell rings
7. Fold this to make a plane
8. A kid's word for your stomach
10. I have my ___ bike now
11. A wink closes one

Puzzle 4

Clean Sweep

Level 4: Adventurer

6 things in a house are hiding in this puzzle. Can you find them?



Level 4: big grids with longer words. Solve a few long words early; they give you letters for lots of short ones.

Across

1. Best friends ___!

3. Pillows and blankets go on it

5. A bird that pulls worms from the lawn in spring

7. Giant ___, a bear with black eye patches that munches bamboo

9. Wash your hair with this

11. Did ___ leave the light on in the hall?

12. You wear this to keep clean while cooking

14. Recess is a ___ from schoolwork

16. "Come and ___, dinner is ready!"

17. We ___ the fireworks from the hill

Down

1. Miles and miles away

2. A big car that holds the whole team

3. A hot dog goes in a ___

4. A sparkly gem, or a kite shape

6. A witch rides one in stories

7. Put your sandwich on this

8. Grandma left a ___ on the phone

9. Use this to dig into a bowl of ice cream

10. Set one more ___ at the dinner table

13. A rodent bigger than a mouse

14. I like apples, ___ I do not like pears

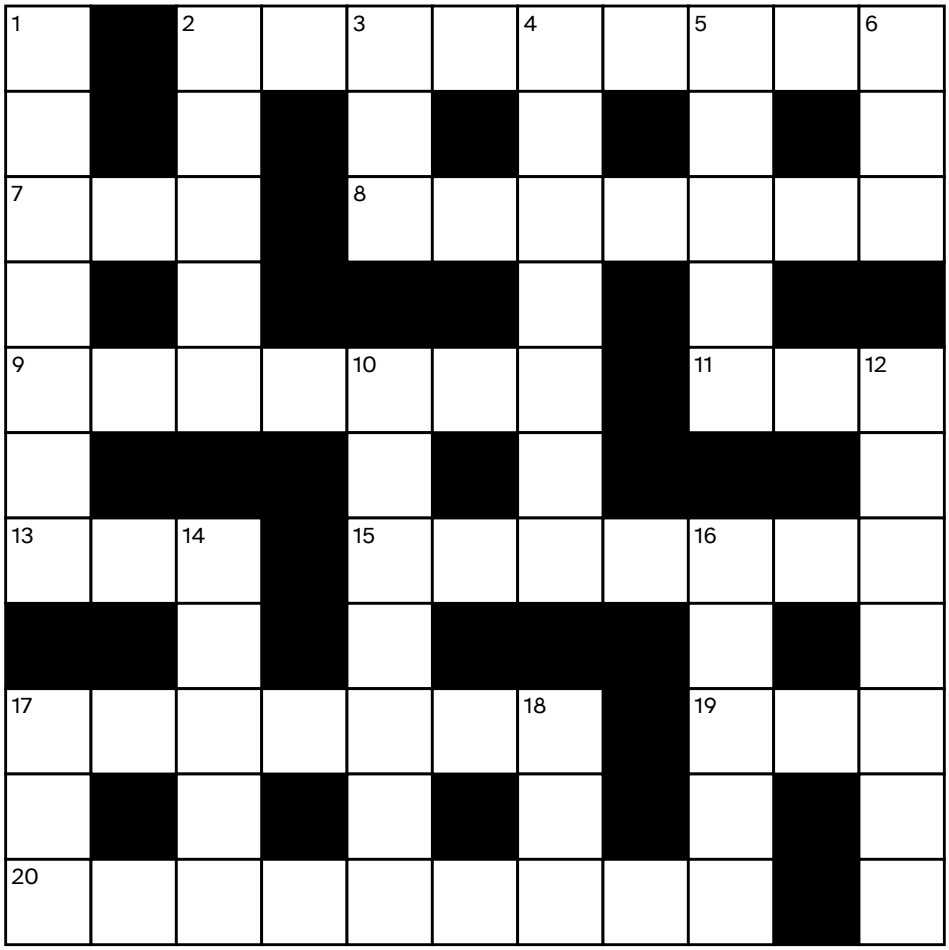
15. Child, for short

Puzzle 5

Level 5: Expert

Team Spirit

Some answers share a hidden theme. Can you work out what it is?



Level 5: harder words and trickier clues. The puzzle no longer tells you what its hidden group is. When you spot a few answers that belong together, you've found the theme!

Across

2. I have ___ to tell you!

7. Frozen water that turns to liquid when warm

8. The person you visit to keep your teeth healthy

9. Changing from a solid to a liquid

11. A room with hoops and climbing ropes

13. Fire trucks are often this color

15. In baseball, this player wears a mask and a big mitt

17. A needle's thread goes ___ the hole

19. Used to glide across snow on your feet

20. The day before today

Down

1. Someone in goggles doing the backstroke

2. Sniff with your nose

3. Rain turns dirt into this

4. May I stay up late ___?

5. Frosting by another name

6. Our class ___ a new fish tank

10. Don't leave anyone out: ___ everyone

12. Breakfast time of day

14. A game of throwing at a bullseye

16. A thick-coated dog that pulls a sled

17. "Just ___ one bite!"

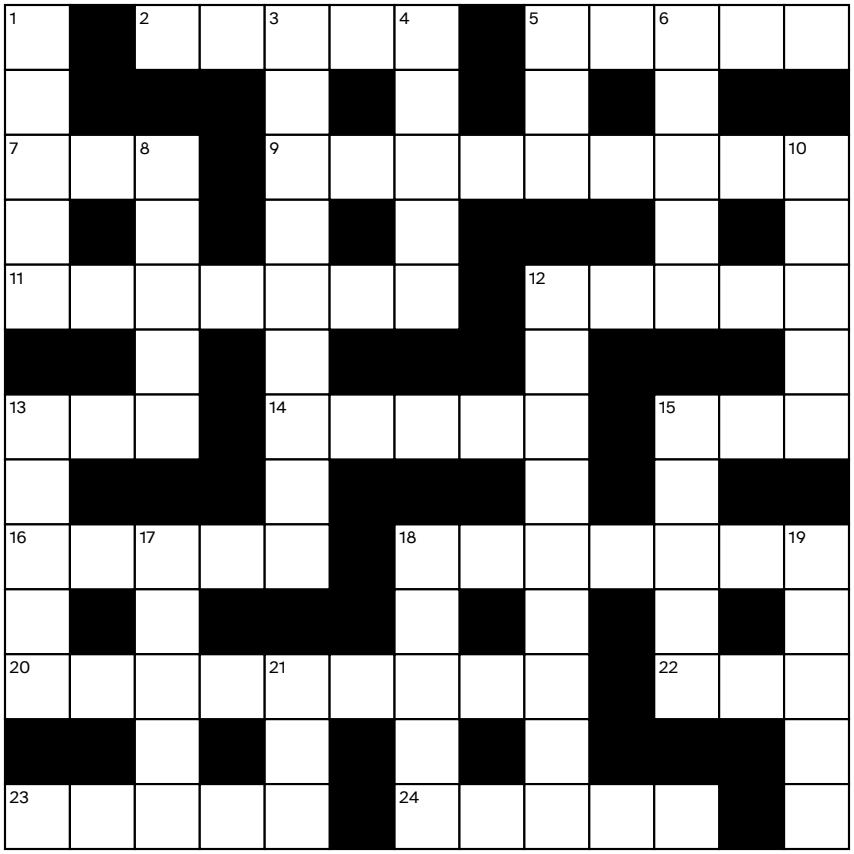
18. We ___ pancakes for breakfast

Puzzle 6

Level 6: Champion

Wide Open Skies

Some answers share a hidden theme. Can you work out what it is?



Level 6: the biggest grids. Take breaks and come back with fresh eyes.

Across

2. Fly these on a windy day
5. A living thing that grows in soil
7. Race across the field
9. It flashes before the thunder
11. To speak in a very quiet voice
12. A gate is part of one
13. Your ___ goes up on your birthday
14. The Atlantic or the Pacific
15. Snip, snip! ___ along the dotted line
16. Each corner of a square is a 90-degree one
18. My heart was ___ fast after the race
20. Glow from the sky on a clear night
22. Fish and whales live in it
23. A one-cent coin
24. Our ___ park is a short walk away

Down

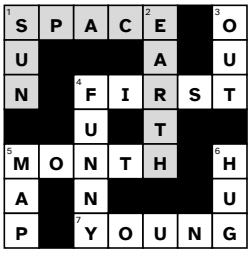
1. ___ the ball to me!
3. Ring, ring! Answer the ___
4. Lemonade needs lemons, water and ___
5. Please ___ a stamp on the letter
6. A visitor from another planet in a story
8. A sound that is often loud
10. The ___ Lakes are five huge lakes in North America
12. Super, amazing, wonderful
13. A loud sound that wakes you up
15. Thin, crispy potato snacks
17. You have ___ so tall!
18. A sesame seed ___ is tasty with cream cheese
19. Green stuff you mow in the yard
21. Hens ___ eggs

Answers

Puzzle 1



Puzzle 2



Puzzle 3



Puzzle 4



Puzzle 5 (theme: sports words)



Puzzle 6 (theme: nature words)

